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Woman Arrested, Dragged Away After Quietly Speaking About Flock at City Council Meeting



MATTHEW GAULT • SEP 23, 2026 AT 10:25 AM

Citizens of Springfield, Missouri showed up to a city council meeting to discuss the city's Flock contract. The mayor shut them down and arrested two people for 'disruption of meetings of city council.'



City Council Bill 2026-213

Regarding Chapter 38, "Building Development Codes," by repealing

IMAGE VIA SPRINGFIELD, MISSOURI.

Mia Hyder had never attended a public meeting before when she showed up to the city council meeting in Springfield, Missouri. After briefly speaking at a podium during a public comment period, she was arrested and dragged away in handcuffs.

"Hello, my name is Mylie Hyder. I'm a Springfield, Missouri constituent, and I'm here to oppose the usage of ALPR cameras, most commonly made by Flock Safety. These cameras are not just surveillance," Hyder started.

"I'm sorry ma'am," Springfield Mayor Jeff Schrag said. Her mic was cut. A cop

Hyder held up both of her middle fingers while continuing to speak: "They are an invasion of our privacy," she said.

The cop said, "You're under arrest," grabbed her arms, and pulled her out of the room. "I can do this all night. I get paid by the hour," the cop added.

"Does this conclude the public hearing," Schrag said.

"Yes sir," a council member responded. The meeting continued with a city employee talking about sidewalk code.



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Hyder was one of two people arrested in Springfield, Missouri on Monday during a city council meeting where tensions rose after the council stalled a review of the city's Flock cameras.

Dozens of people showed up to the Springfield City Council Meeting on September 22 with plans to let city leaders know how they felt about the city's use of automated license plate readers. There was a resolution before the council that would trigger a review of the controversial camera systems, but Schrag moved to send the resolution to committee and prevent public comment on the issue.

The move passed 5 - 3, the crowd shouted at city leaders, and Schrag ordered citizens to clear the room and shut off cameras recording the event. As people left, police detained and ticketed Noah Powell. Later in the evening Mia Hyder tried to speak out about Flock during public comments about a housing issue. Police arrested her while Schrag looked on. "Sorry ma'm," the mayor said as police led Hyder away in handcuffs.

Springfield has [41 Flock cameras](#), according to the Flock Transparency Portal. City councilor Brandon Jenson had proposed a resolution to "conduct a comprehensive review of all relevant contracts" related to the ALPR cameras. The council was set to vote on Jenson's proposed review on Monday and hear comments from the community. But when the resolution came up during the meeting, Mayor Schrag immediately pushed to send it to a committee and avoid public comment.

Jenson spoke before the vote to push the resolution to a committee. "All I'm trying to do is get people answers to some real questions that they've brought to us for months. And it's a shame that it comes to this sort of, I guess, theater that I'm a part of to try to get those answers," he said. "This isn't how government is supposed to run. It's just disappointing. And we're not even allowing folks to speak who clearly came out to share their voices tonight."

0:00 / 0:42 

1x



When the council voted to send the bill to committee, someone in the crowd shouted "Bullshit!" Schrag tried to move on to the next agenda item, but the crowd booed and yelled. The mayor then paused the meeting, turned off the cameras, and cleared the room.

Police detained Powell, a freelance photographer in Springfield, as people filed out of the room. "I don't have a lot of experience getting tickets or being detained," Powell told 404 Media. "So this is kind of new for me."

Footage obtained by 404 Media showed several people leaving the city council meeting and yelling at city leaders. Powell said he was the only person put in handcuffs, detained, and ticketed at that moment. The Springfield Police Department did not return 404 Media's request for comment.

"Well, I said: 'Jeff Schrag is a cuck.' I said: 'Fuck you Jeff.' I said: 'Worthless' and then, also, the final thing I said was: 'Jeff Schrag has a tiny, stinky, cock,'" Powell explained. "I just let myself get handcuffed and let them do whatever power trip they wanted to do. Got my ticket and left."

Powell said he was only in handcuffs for five minutes. "They just wanted to put on a show," he explained. Powell added that he planned to fight the charge in court. "I've already sought legal representation, so we're going to see where it gets [...] I don't think I should have been put in cuffs. I read the law, the city ordinance, and it said that I should have just been asked to leave."

Hyder told 404 Media that she'd just moved to the area and thought that the city council meeting would be a good place to get involved in the community. She said that she'd stayed behind when Schrag cleared the room earlier in the evening. "I don't know why I stayed. I just felt like not staying was giving up," she said. Hyder explained that she waited until the public comment period for a different issue, filled out a form to talk, and then got up to deliver a written statement about Flock cameras. She said she didn't flip off the city council until she saw the police officer approaching.

"After I saw the police officer out of the corner of my eye and everyone was kind of yelling at me, and there was a lot of ruckus, that's when I pulled out the double birds," she said.



Seen something at a city council meeting? I would love to hear from you. Using a non-work device, you can message me securely on Signal at +1 347 762-9212 or send me an email at matthew@404media.co.

The police officer who arrested her said Hyder was being charged with disrupting the peace. He took her into the hallway outside of the meeting and held her in handcuffs for around five minutes before issuing her a ticket and letting her go.

Hyder told 404 Media she didn't regret it. "I feel like being silent would have been like being complicit," she said. "I felt like it was kind of stupid that I disturbed the peace. Okay, yeah, I did flip them off. That wasn't a shining moment, but I did that when I was about to be arrested. When I knew my time was up."

Hyder added she'd continue to attend city council meetings.

UNIFORM CITATION

RI NO. M00390300
PRINGFIELD POLICE DEPARTMENT
TATE OF MISSOURI

161424097

I THE ☐ CIRCUIT COURT OF GREENE COUNTY
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☒ MUNICIPAL COURT OF SPRINGFIELD, MISSOURI
625 N. BENTON 65806 • 417-864-1890 • ORI MO 039011J

COURT DATE 12/3/26 COURT TIME 900 ☒ AM ☐ PM

, KNOWING THAT FALSE STATEMENTS ON THIS FORM ARE PUNISHABLE BY LAW, STATE
THAT I HAVE PROBABLE CAUSE TO BELIEVE THAT:

ABOUT (DATE) 11/21/26 AT TIME 1915 HRS UPON/AT OR NEAR (LOCATION) 2620 W Battlefield
WITHIN CITY/COUNTY AND STATE AFORESAID.

NAME (LAST, FIRST, MIDDLE) HYDER, MYKE
STREET ADDRESS [REDACTED] PHONE # [REDACTED]

CITY SPRINGFIELD STATE MO ZIP CODE [REDACTED]

DATE OF BIRTH [REDACTED] RACE W SEX F HEIGHT [REDACTED] WEIGHT [REDACTED]

RIVER'S LIC. NO. [REDACTED] CDL ☐ YES ☒ NO STATE MO

EMPLOYER [REDACTED]

ADDRESS (STREET, CITY, STATE, ZIP) [REDACTED]

ID UNLAWFULLY		☐ OPERATE/DRIVE	☐ PARK	☐ C.M.V.	☐ WITH HAZ MAT
YEAR	MAKE	MODEL	STYLE	COLOR	
REGISTERED WEIGHT		LIC NUMBER	STATE	YEAR	

ASDAJ TRAFFIC

ID THEN AND THERE COMMIT THE FOLLOWING OFFENSE. THE FACTS SUPPORTING THIS
ELIEF ARE AS FOLLOWS:

DISTURBANCE OF CITY
COUNCIL MTG - MIDDLE FINGER

I Subject taken into custody. (Complete "For Issuance of a Warrant" section on reverse side)

IVING	POSTED SPEED LIMIT	DETECTION METHOD
MPH	MPH	☐ STATIONARY RADAR ☐ WATCH (AIR) ☐ PACE
DAR #	FORK #	☐ MOVING RADAR ☐ WATCH (GROUND) ☐ OTHER

AT BELT VIOLATION: STATUTE/ORDINANCE - CHARGE CODE			
RSMo			
ORD.			
IN FATAL CRASH ☐	IN CRASH ☐	DWI/BAC ☐	REPORT # 26-27411
FICER [Signature]		BADGE 1493	TRP/ZONE DATE 9/26/20
INFORMATION, UNDERSIGNED PROSECUTOR CHARGES THE DEFENDANT AND FORMS THE COURT THAT ABOVE FACTS ARE TRUE AND PUNISHABLE BY:			☐ RSMo ☐ ORD.
PROSECUTOR'S SIGNATURE		DATE	
I PROMISE TO DISPOSE OF THE CHARGES OF WHICH I AM ACCUSED THROUGH COURT APPEARANCE OR PREPAYMENT OF FINE AND COURT COSTS.			DR. LIC. POSTED ☐ YES ☐ NO
SIGNATURE X			
100-0051 (1-17)			

ABSTRACT OF COURT RECORD

A COPY OF HYDER'S TICKET.

Flock Out SGF, a local group that's lobbying against ALPRs in Springfield, told 404 Media that the resolution was meant as a compromise. "Many people came out to the council meeting and had carefully prepared statements for public comment, but no citizens were heard," they said. "The two individuals who were arrested for voicing their concerns in the face of being silenced were not unreasonable, and we stand by their actions."

Watch Body Cam of Man Arrested for Just Cussing at a County Meeting

Powell and Hyder are just the two latest American citizens detained or arrested. Cops followed EJ Carrion home and arrested him in his driveway one week after this year for their behavior during a city council meeting. In February a farmer he said 'bullshit' at a county meeting in Texas, was arrested in Oklahoma for going over his time during a data center meeting.

 MATTHEW GAULT · SEP 24, 2026
In Kansas, police arrested a high school teacher for clapping during public comments. In Texas, cops arrested a man in his driveway for public disturbance a week after he said "bullshit" during a county meeting.

Springfield did not return 404 Media's request for comment.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Matthew Gault is a writer covering weird tech, nuclear war, and video games. He's worked for Reuters, Motherboard, and the New York Times.



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